SHOW AND TELL: Rhythm and swag. The unfiltered storm girl. And satire in five languages

SRUSHTI TAWADE *Rapper, Writer, Satirist*

A RAP ON SOCIETY

> **Throughout my childhood, I worried about what people thought about me. But when I started writing after my teenage, at the age of 20, my perspective towards life changed. I gained a lot of confidence**

Srushti Tawade, who broke the internet with her rap verses on the reality show *MTV Hustle 2.0*, brought the house down at the India Today Conclave with her skills. With songs like 'Bachpan' and 'Main Nahi Toh Kaun', which have cumulatively amassed more than 120 million views on YouTube, the Mumbai-based artist offered a glimpse of her storytelling skills, wit and, more significantly, swagger, arguably the most important element that gives hip-hop its appeal.

Only 23 and a fresh voice on the rap scene, Tawade is a prime example of how India's Generation Z is unafraid to share their thoughts and feelings, and, in the process, even be a bit vulnerable. She also spoke about the growing interest in rap as a form of music in India, and being one of the many young artists on the scene today. "Until now, I have been at a beginner level when it comes to rap, because I don't know much about the rap scene or rap terminologies, meaning I don't know the grammar of rap. But I have things to say, whether it's through rap, songs, or stories. I enjoy speaking in every way possible. So, it's just like a beautiful accident that I became popular as a rapper while I was writing other things as well."

A beautiful accident it may have been, but it's certainly grit and unfiltered honesty that have propelled Tawade to national acclaim today. ■



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KEY TAKEAWAYS

- We can make a good art of rap and entertain people by praising someone instead of humiliating or 'dissing' them. It is possible
- There is as much scope in rap as there is in mainstream Bollywood music or the music we commonly listen to; it just hasn't been explored yet
- What happens in your childhood and traumatic events at a young age can leave a lasting impact on your life